PROJECT QUOTE / RATE SHEET

The Rate Guide — Freelancer's Contract Pack

Send this before the contract. It's your professional estimate — not a binding agreement until the contract is signed.

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

This is your pre-contract quote. Send it when a client asks "what would something like this cost?" — before you've committed to terms. It sets expectations, shows you've thought through the scope, and filters clients who aren't serious.

The quote is not a contract. The Freelance Services Agreement (Document 1) is the contract.

Fill every `[BLANK]`. Delete annotation text before sending.

PROJECT QUOTE

`[Your Name or Business Name]`

`[Your Email]` | `[Your Phone — optional]`

`[Your Website — optional]`

Prepared for: `[Client Name / Company]`

Contact: `[Client Email]`

Quote Date: `[Date]`

Quote Valid Until: `[Date — set this 14 days out. Quotes shouldn't be open-ended.]`

> ***Why an expiration date?*** *Your rate is based on current availability. A quote you sent three months ago may not reflect*

> *to ask again.*

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Project Name: [What is this project called?]

Project Type: [Commercial / Documentary / Branded Content / Corporate / Music Video / Narrative Short / Event / Other]

Your Role: [DP / Editor / Colorist / Motion Designer / Producer / Other]

Brief Description:

[One to two sentences describing what this project is and what you're being asked to do. Write it based on what the client told you — this shows you were listening and that you understand the scope.]

Example: "A 90-second brand film for [Client], to be used across digital platforms and at trade shows. Client needs a one-day shoot in Los Angeles and a rough cut delivered within 10 days of wrap."

SCOPE OF WORK

[List what you're agreeing to do. Be specific. Vague scope = scope creep. The more detail here, the less room for "I thought that was included."]

- [Item 1 — e.g., Cinematography / direction of photography for 1 shoot day (up to 10 hours)]
- [Item 2 — e.g., Camera package provided by Contractor — see equipment list below]
- [Item 3 — e.g., Offline edit — assembly cut through final cut]
- [Item 4 — e.g., Color grade and output — one version per deliverable spec]
- [Item 5 — e.g., Two rounds of client revisions included]

Not included in this quote:

[List what you're explicitly NOT doing. This prevents assumptions.]

- [e.g., Sound mix / audio post]
- [e.g., Music licensing]
- [e.g., Motion graphics or title cards]
- [e.g., Stock footage]
- [e.g., Raw footage delivery — available for additional fee — see below]

- [e.g., Additional shoot days beyond what's listed]

> ***Why list exclusions?*** *Clients assume everything is included unless you tell them otherwise. Listing exclusions is not defensive — it's professional. It shows you've thought through the full scope and it prevents an awkward conversation after the project.*

LINE-ITEM PRICING

> **DECISION** *Use whichever billing model applies to this project. Delete the others.*

OPTION A — DAY RATE BILLING

ITEM	DAYS / UNITS	RATE	TOTAL
[Shoot Day(s) — Role]	[X] days	$ [Rate] /day	$ [X × Rate]
[Additional Shoot Day]	[X] days	$ [Rate] /day	$ [X × Rate]
[Overtime (if applicable)]	[X] hours	$ [Rate] /hr	$ [X × Rate]
[Post-Production / Edit]	[X] days	$ [Rate] /day	$ [X × Rate]
Subtotal	$ **[Total]**		

OPTION B — PROJECT RATE BILLING

ITEM	DESCRIPTION	COST
Pre-Production	[Prep, scout, calls — X days]	$ [Amount]
Production	[Shoot — X days]	$ [Amount]
Post-Production	[Edit, grade, delivery — X days]	$ [Amount]
Project Total	$ **[Total]**	

OPTION C — HYBRID (SHOOT DAYS + POST FLAT RATE)

ITEM	DAYS	RATE	TOTAL
Shoot Day — [Role]	[X]	$ [Rate] /day	$ [X × Rate]
Post-Production (flat)	—	—	$ [Amount]
Total	$ **[Total]**		

EQUIPMENT AND MATERIALS

> **DECISION** *Include this section if you're providing equipment and billing for it. Skip it if you're a post-production or services-only freelancer. Equipment fees are separate from your labor rate.*

ITEM	PER DAY	DAYS	TOTAL
[Camera Package — e.g., ARRI Alexa Mini + lenses]	$ [Rate] /day	[X]	$ [Total]
[Lighting Kit]	$ [Rate] /day	[X]	$ [Total]
[Drone / Specialty Equipment]	$ [Rate] /day	[X]	$ [Total]
[Data / Media]	$ [Flat Fee]	—	$ [Total]
Equipment Subtotal	**$ [Total]**		

> ***Note on equipment rates:*** *Equipment fees are separate from your labor rate for the same reason a plumber charges for their time AND their tools. You own, insure, and maintain this equipment — billing for its use is standard professional practice.*

OPTIONAL ADD-ONS

[List things the client might want that aren't in the base scope. Giving them options is better than having them ask you to add things later at an awkward moment.]

ADD-ON	PRICE
Raw footage delivery (all media from shoot)	$ [Amount]
Additional revision round (beyond 2 included)	$ [Amount]
Expedited delivery (within [X] days)	+$ [Amount]
[Additional deliverable — e.g., social cut / vertical format]	$ [Amount]
[Additional shoot day]	$ [Day Rate] /day

PROJECT TOTAL

Labor Subtotal	$ [Amount]
Equipment Subtotal	$ [Amount]
Estimated Expenses	$ [Amount]
PROJECT TOTAL	**$ [Total]**

> **DECISION** *Don't underestimate expenses to make the quote look lower. Give a realistic range — "approximately $150–300 in expenses, reimbursed on receipt." Surprising a client with expenses they didn't expect is worse than showing them upfront.*

PAYMENT TERMS

- **Deposit:** [25–50%] ($ [Amount]) due upon project confirmation. Non-refundable.
- **Remaining Balance:** Due [Net 15 / Net 30] from delivery date.
- **Late Payments:** [1.5] % per month on unpaid balances past due.

SCHEDULE

MILESTONE	ESTIMATED DATE
Deposit / Project confirmation	[Date]
Shoot day(s)	[Date(s)]
First cut / rough grade delivered	[Date]
Client feedback due	[Date]
Final delivery	[Date]

> **DECISION** *Feedback deadlines matter. If a client takes six weeks to review your first cut, the project drags on forever. Include client feedback deadlines in your timeline — it establishes that both parties have obligations, not just you.*

TO PROCEED

To confirm this project:

1. Review and approve this quote by responding to this email.

2. Sign the attached Freelance Services Agreement.

3. Submit deposit of `$[Amount]` via `[Payment method — e.g., wire / ACH / Venmo Business / check]`.

Work will begin upon receipt of signed contract and deposit.

Questions?

`[Your Name]` | `[Email]` | `[Phone — optional]`

Prepared with The Rate Guide Freelancer's Contract Pack. therateguide.com